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Senior Engineering Manager, Site Reliability

Apply

 United States | Remote

About Upstart

At Upstart, we're united by a mission that matters: to radically reduce the cost and complexity of borrowing for all Americans. Every day, we bring creativity, experimentation, and advanced AI to reshape access to credit, helping millions move forward financially with clarity and confidence.

As the leading AI lending marketplace, we partner with banks and credit unions to expand access to affordable credit through technology that's both radically intelligent and deeply human. Our platform runs over one million predictions per borrower using more than 3,000 signals, powering smarter, fairer decisions for millions of customers. But the numbers only hint at the impact. Every idea, every voice, and every contribution moves us closer to a world where credit never stands between people and their financial progress.

We're proudly digital-first, giving most Upstarters the flexibility to do their best work from wherever they thrive, alongside teammates across 80+ cities in the US and Canada. Digital-first doesn't mean distant. We're intentional about in-person connection through team onsite, planning sessions, and moments that spark creativity and trust. And whether you choose to work primarily from home or collaborate in-person from one of our offices in Columbus, Austin, the Bay Area, or New York City (opening Summer 2026), you'll have the support to work in the way that works best for you.

If you're energized by tackling meaningful problems, excited to innovate with purpose, and motivated by work that truly matters, we'd love to hear from you.

The Team:

The Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) team enables Upstart's engineering organization to operate reliable, observable, and resilient systems at scale. The team owns company-wide

incident management practices, reliability standards, operational readiness, and the capabilities that help engineering teams identify, respond to, and learn from production issues.

Our goal is to make reliability an integrated part of how software is designed, delivered, and operated. We are building a model where engineering teams have the trusted signals, automated safeguards, and operational practices needed to move quickly while protecting our customers and business.

The team advances observability, incident detection and response, service level objectives, operational readiness, and systemic improvements based on incident learnings. SRE partners across product engineering, infrastructure, security, and platform teams to improve reliability at scale.

The Role:

As the Senior Engineering Manager of Site Reliability Engineering, you will lead a team responsible for improving the reliability and operational maturity of Upstart's products and services. You will drive high impact improvements across incident management, observability, operational readiness, and reliability engineering.

You will serve as the accountable leader of the SRE function, translating reliability strategy into focused plans, clear ownership, and measurable outcomes. You will partner closely with engineering leaders to establish reliability expectations, identify systemic risks, and build scalable capabilities that enable teams to operate services safely and independently.

This role is suited for a hands-on leader with strong technical judgment, disciplined execution, and a track record of building high performing teams. You will balance immediate operational needs with durable improvements that reduce risk, strengthen resilience, and improve how Upstart learns from production.

How you'll make an impact

Team Leadership and Execution

- Manage and develop a team focused on incident management, observability, operational readiness, and reliability engineering
- Define a clear charter, priorities, roadmap, and measurable outcomes for the SRE function
- Translate strategy into capacity aware plans with explicit trade offs, ownership, milestones, and success measures

- Maintain visibility into delivery health, operational risks, and team performance, intervening early when execution drifts
- Build a resilient operating model through cross-training, shared context, effective delegation, and clear primary and secondary ownership
- Set a high bar for technical quality, operating rigor, and executive communication
- Develop engineers and leaders who can independently own complex reliability initiatives

Incident Management and Learning

- Evolve Upstart's incident management program to improve detection, response, coordination, communication, and recovery
- Establish clear standards for managing high severity incidents and provide visible leadership during critical events
- Improve postmortem quality and ensure incident learnings result in durable engineering improvements
- Identify recurring failure patterns and drive systemic solutions across teams
- Create strong feedback loops from incidents into roadmaps, service standards, operational readiness requirements, and measurable risk reduction

Observability and Reliability Engineering

- Improve the quality, accessibility, and trustworthiness of signals used to understand production health
- Drive consistent practices across metrics, logs, traces, alerting, and service health
- Advance the use of service level objectives and customer impact signals to guide priorities and operational decisions
- Reduce detection gaps, noisy alerts, manual investigation, and recurring operational toil
- Define measurable reliability outcomes and use data to prioritize investments and communicate impact
- Partner with platform and product engineering teams to embed reliability into standard engineering workflows

Operational Readiness and Resilience

- Establish scalable operational readiness standards for new services, major launches, and architectural changes
- Set clear expectations for service ownership, monitoring, capacity, failure handling, and incident response

- Identify systemic reliability risks and partner with engineering teams to prioritize and address them
- Improve resilience through automation, failure testing, recovery capabilities, and operational safeguards
- Build operating mechanisms that turn reviews and analysis into clear decisions, owners, timelines, and sustained follow through
- Align stakeholders and dependencies before critical launches and engineering decisions

Minimum Qualifications

- 5+ years of reliability engineering management experience and 7+ years of experience in software engineering, site reliability engineering, infrastructure, or platform engineering
- Significant hands-on experience in Site Reliability Engineering, Production Engineering, or an equivalent role responsible for operating and improving production systems
- Direct experience managing an SRE, Production Engineering, or equivalent reliability function, including ownership of its strategy, roadmap, operating model, and outcomes
- Strong technical depth in distributed systems, cloud infrastructure, observability, and production operations
- Experience leading high severity incident response and improving incident management practices at scale
- Demonstrated ability to translate strategy into focused, capacity aware plans and deliver measurable outcomes
- Track record of hiring, developing, and retaining high performing engineers and engineering leaders
- Strong cross-functional leadership and communication, with the ability to turn complex operational data into clear decisions and drive alignment across teams

Preferred Qualifications

- Experience operating large scale, highly available distributed systems
- Experience implementing or evolving service-level objectives and error-budget practices
- Experience with observability platforms such as Datadog, Grafana, Prometheus, OpenTelemetry, or similar technologies

- Experience developing incident management, operational readiness, or resilience programs across a large engineering organization
- Familiarity with Kubernetes, AWS, and modern cloud native architectures
- Experience supporting major platform or architectural transitions
- Strong product mindset when building internal reliability capabilities
- Experience establishing executive level reliability reporting and operating reviews

Position location This role is available in the following locations: Remote

Travel requirements As a digital first company, the majority of your work can be accomplished remotely. The majority of our employees can live and work anywhere in the U.S but are encouraged to still spend high quality time in-person collaborating via regular onsites. The in-person sessions' cadence varies depending on the team and role; most teams meet once or twice per quarter for 2-4 consecutive days at a time.

#LI-REMOTE

#LI-MidSenior

At Upstart, your base pay is one part of your total compensation package. The anticipated base salary for this position is expected to be within the below range. Your actual base pay will depend on your geographic location—with our “digital first” philosophy, Upstart uses compensation regions that vary depending on location. Individual pay is also determined by job-related skills, experience, and relevant education or training. Your recruiter can share more about the specific salary range for your preferred location during the hiring process.

In addition, Upstart provides employees with target bonuses, equity compensation, and generous benefits packages (including medical, dental, vision, and 401k).

United States | Remote - Anticipated Base Salary Range

\$195,300 - \$270,400 USD

What you'll love

At Upstart, our benefits are designed to support your health, financial well-being, family, and personal growth. Here's what you can expect:

- Competitive compensation, including base pay, bonus opportunities, and annual equity grants that vest quarterly
- Retirement benefits to help you plan for the future, including a 401(k) or Group Retirement Savings Plan with a company match of \$2 for every \$1 contributed, up to \$15,000 annually (USD in the US, CAD in Canada)
- Employee Stock Purchase Plan (ESPP) with discounted stock purchase options for eligible employees (US only)
- Comprehensive health coverage designed to support you and your family, including medical, dental, vision, and wellness resources for US and supplemental health coverage for Canada.
- Health Savings Account contributions from Upstart for eligible plans (US only)
- Income protection benefits, including life insurance and disability coverage for added financial security
- Paid time off, sick leave, and company holidays, in line with local requirements
- Paid family and parental leave to support caregiving and major life moments (duration varies by country)
- Family-centered benefits to support fertility, parenthood, and caregiving needs
- Employee Assistance Program (EAP) offering mental health support and life-centered resources
- Financial wellness resources, including access to financial planning tools and a financial concierge service (US Only)
- Annual wellness allowance to support your physical and emotional well-being and personal development, based on what matters most to you
- Annual productivity allowance to invest in relevant tools and resources you need to do your best work, no matter where you work from
- Connection and community through team events, all-company updates, and employee resource groups (ERGs)
- Onsite perks, including catered lunches and fully stocked micro-kitchens when working from one of our offices in the Bay Area, Austin, Columbus, and New York City (opening Summer 2026!)

For roles based in Canada, please note that we are not currently able to hire in Quebec.

Upstart is a proud Equal Opportunity Employer. Just as we are dedicated to improving access to affordable credit for all, we are committed to inclusive and fair hiring practices.

If you require reasonable accommodation in completing an application, interviewing, completing any pre-employment testing, or otherwise participating in the employee selection process, please email candidate_accommodations@upstart.com

https://www.upstart.com/candidate_privacy_policy

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Autofill my application

* indicates a required field

First Name *

Last Name *

Email *

Country *



Phone *

Location (City) *

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Resume/CV *

Attach

Dropbox

Enter manually

Accepted file types: pdf, doc, docx, txt, rtf

Cover Letter

[Attach](#)[Dropbox](#)[Enter manually](#)

Accepted file types: pdf, doc, docx, txt, rtf

What is your current location? Please note we are unable to hire candidates based in Quebec at this time. *

Select...

Location Preference *

- ☐ San Mateo, CA
- ☐ Columbus, OH
- ☐ Austin, TX
- ☐ Remote

As a digital-first company, we are providing our employees with the opportunity to work remotely across the US and/or from one of our physical office locations.

Please select from the list below your primary work location preference(s). Primary work location is defined as where you will spend more than 50% of your time working. Before making your selection(s), please check to make sure that the location is listed as an option in the job's description above. Multiple selections can be made if multiple locations are available. Remote is considered a location.

Do you need, or will you need in the future, any immigration-related support or sponsorship from the Company in order to begin or continue employment with the Company? This includes support (such as J-1, F-1 CPT letter or STEM OPT Training Plan), visa sponsorship for employment (H-1B, H-1B1, E-3, O-1, or TN), and any EAD holders that will need longer term employment authorization (temporary work visa or permanent residency). *

Select...

Before applying, how familiar were you with Upstart? *

Select...

Before applying, how did you hear about Upstart? *

Select...

Have you been employed by Upstart before? *

Select... ▼

LinkedIn Profile ***Website**

Voluntary Self-Identification

For government reporting purposes, we ask candidates to respond to the below self-identification survey. Completion of the form is entirely voluntary. Whatever your decision, it will not be considered in the hiring process or thereafter. Any information that you do provide will be recorded and maintained in a confidential file.

As set forth in Upstart's Equal Employment Opportunity policy, we do not discriminate on the basis of any protected group status under any applicable law.

Gender *

Select... ▼

Are you Hispanic/Latino? *

Select... ▼

Race & Ethnicity Definitions

If you believe you belong to any of the categories of protected veterans listed below, please indicate by making the appropriate selection. As a government contractor subject to the Vietnam Era Veterans Readjustment Assistance Act (VEVRAA), we request this information in order to measure the effectiveness of the outreach and positive recruitment efforts we undertake pursuant to VEVRAA. Classification of protected categories is as follows:

A "disabled veteran" is one of the following: a veteran of the U.S. military, ground, naval or air service who is entitled to compensation (or who but for the receipt of military retired pay would be entitled to compensation) under laws administered by the Secretary of Veterans Affairs; or a person who was discharged or released from active duty because of a service-connected disability.

A "recently separated veteran" means any veteran during the three-year period beginning on the date of such veteran's discharge or release from active duty in the U.S. military, ground, naval, or air service.

An "active duty wartime or campaign badge veteran" means a veteran who served on active duty in the U.S. military, ground, naval or air service during a war, or in a campaign or expedition for which a campaign badge has been authorized under the laws administered by the Department of Defense.

An "Armed forces service medal veteran" means a veteran who, while serving on active duty in the U.S. military, ground, naval or air service, participated in a United States military operation for which an Armed Forces service medal was awarded pursuant to Executive Order 12985.

Veteran Status *

Select...



Voluntary Self-Identification of Disability

Form CC-305

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OMB Control Number 1250-0005

Expires 07/31/2029

Why are you being asked to complete this form?

We are a federal contractor or subcontractor. The law requires us to provide equal employment opportunity to qualified people with disabilities. We have a goal of having at least 7% of our workers as people with disabilities. The law says we must measure our progress towards this goal. To do this, we must ask applicants and employees if they have a disability or have ever had one. People can become disabled, so we need to ask this question at least every five years.

Completing this form is voluntary, and we hope that you will choose to do so. Your answer is confidential. No one who makes hiring decisions will see it. Your decision to complete the form and your answer will not harm you in any way. If you want to learn more about the law or this form, visit the U.S. Department of Labor's Office of Federal Contract Compliance Programs (OFCCP) website at www.dol.gov/ofccp.

How do you know if you have a disability?

A disability is a condition that substantially limits one or more of your "major life activities." If you have or have ever had such a condition, you are a person with a disability. **Disabilities**

include, but are not limited to:

- Alcohol or other substance use disorder (not currently using drugs illegally)
- Autoimmune disorder, for example, lupus, fibromyalgia, rheumatoid arthritis, HIV/AIDS
- Blind or low vision
- Cancer (past or present)
- Cardiovascular or heart disease
- Celiac disease
- Cerebral palsy
- Deaf or serious difficulty hearing
- Diabetes
- Disfigurement, for example, disfigurement caused by burns, wounds, accidents, or congenital disorders
- Epilepsy or other seizure disorder
- Gastrointestinal disorders, for example, Crohn's Disease, irritable bowel syndrome
- Intellectual or developmental disability
- Mental health conditions, for example, depression, bipolar disorder, anxiety disorder, schizophrenia, PTSD
- Missing limbs or partially missing limbs
- Mobility impairment, benefiting from the use of a wheelchair, scooter, walker, leg brace(s) and/or other supports
- Nervous system condition, for example, migraine headaches, Parkinson's disease, multiple sclerosis (MS)
- Neurodivergence, for example, attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD), autism spectrum disorder, dyslexia, dyspraxia, other learning disabilities
- Partial or complete paralysis (any cause)
- Pulmonary or respiratory conditions, for example, tuberculosis, asthma, emphysema
- Short stature (dwarfism)
- Traumatic brain injury

Disability Status *

Select...



PUBLIC BURDEN STATEMENT: According to the Paperwork Reduction Act of 1995 no persons are required to respond to a collection of information unless such collection displays a valid OMB control number. This survey should take about 5 minutes to complete.

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